Mathew Garcia

AI Product & Infrastructure Lead • Mobile + Cloud • FinOps

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Professional Summary

AI product and infrastructure lead with 13 years across cloud operations, FinOps and applied machine learning. In 2026, led the MagisAI 2.0 rebuild from a no-code app to a native Kotlin Multiplatform codebase released on both app stores, moved its inference to serverless GPUs at under a cent per answer, and shipped a second app, Pray Serve, for the Diocese of Orange. Fine-tunes and serves open models, builds retrieval systems with measured accuracy, and keeps the cost model honest from GPU hour to board slide.

Certifications

- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner
- FinOps Certified Practitioner

Key Skills

- **AI/ML Engineering:** LLM fine-tuning (LoRA, QLoRA, SFT, RAFT), vLLM and AWQ quantization, RunPod Serverless, hybrid RAG with pgvector, eval harnesses, HITL curation
- **Product Engineering:** Kotlin Multiplatform, Compose, Android and iOS release, Next.js 15, TypeScript, Firebase, RevenueCat, Python, FastAPI
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS, GCP (Firebase, Cloud Run, Secret Manager), Vercel, RunPod serverless GPUs, Docker, Terraform, GitHub Actions
- **FinOps:** AI inference unit economics, warm/cold GPU scheduling, cost guardrails, reserved instances, capacity planning, board-level projections
- **Compliance & Security:** COPPA, FERPA, RBAC, Firestore security rules, App Check, secret management, privacy and retention programs
- **Leadership:** Technical strategy, platform selection, board reporting, vendor management, AI-assisted multi-agent engineering workflow

Professional Experience

Head of MagisAI Infrastructure and Cloud Operations

Magis Center for Reason and Faith (05/2024 – Present)

- Lead all technology for MagisAI, a Catholic educational AI assistant with about 23,000 registered accounts and 16,000 active users, from model training and inference to the native apps, the web app and every store release.
- Led the MagisAI 2.0 rebuild: replaced a FlutterFlow app with one Kotlin Multiplatform codebase that ships native Android and iOS together, approved by both stores on October 21, 2026 and released November 1 with 46.8k lines of code, 19 screens, 710 passing automated tests and five interface languages.
- Built the 2.0 client platform: a Vercel gateway that enforces per-tier question quotas server-side, Firebase Auth and Firestore with emulator-tested security rules, TypeScript Cloud Functions, RevenueCat subscriptions and a Cloud Run text-to-speech service; shipped the Next.js web app in six languages with structured-data SEO and a notifications portal for the marketing team.
- Re-platformed inference from always-on AWS to RunPod serverless vLLM that scales to zero: quantized Qwen2.5-14B from 65.5 GB to 19.3 GB (AWQ 4-bit) to run on 48 GB GPUs, and built the GPU operations dashboard with queue and error alerts, guarded scaling and keys held in Secret Manager.
- Modeled 2027 unit economics from 11 months of usage (387,548 questions): a 14-hour warm-GPU schedule covers 82% of traffic at about $18k a year versus $31k always-on, with compute

under one cent per answer; retired $3,600 a year of legacy servers, moved about 95% of traffic off third-party LLM billing, and caught a misconfiguration running at a $73k-a-year pace by reading the live bill, fixing it the same day.
- Built the model training platform: Axolotl on RunPod Serverless for LoRA, QLoRA and RAFT fine-tuning of Qwen2.5-14B with a web UI, a human-in-the-loop Q&A curation tool, LLM-as-judge evaluation and Hugging Face Hub publishing; the resulting MagisAI 1.0 adapter serves production answers.
- Co-built the retrieval layer that replaced a hosted Weaviate agent: Postgres with pgvector and BGE embeddings over a 2,915-record corpus, hybrid semantic and doctrinal ranking, citation auditing and golden-query checks; 175 of 175 in-scope test questions retrieved relevant passages.
- Owned launch readiness for a 13+ audience: COPPA assessment against the current FTC rule, written security and retention programs for counsel review, privacy policy and terms, age screening and in-app account deletion, and App Store and Google Play submission; report launch status and cost projections to the board.
- Earlier ran the 1.0 platform on multi-region AWS (US, EU, APAC and LATAM) with automated failover and cut its cloud spend by 80% through reserved instances, savings plans and capacity planning; prototyped the FERPA-oriented SafeChat Monitor for schools and built the analytics pipelines (Google Analytics, App Store Connect and Play Console into Plotly dashboards) that now feed the usage model.

Founder & Principal Engineer

Stack 26 (05/2026 – Present)

- Built and shipped Pray Serve for the Diocese of Orange, a Kotlin Multiplatform app on the App Store (August 2026) and Google Play (production release October 2026) that helps young Catholics log prayer and service; Firebase backend with TypeScript Cloud Functions for push notifications, challenges, leaderboards, role claims and lectionary publishing, plus a CI check that catches security-rule drift between repositories.
- Delivered the organizer portal (Next.js 15) where parishes and approved nonprofits publish opportunities, with a diocese review queue, cohorts with invite codes and rosters.
- Built a dependency-free Node ETL on GitHub Actions that publishes 1,138 worship times for 71 parishes to Firestore every week behind a human review gate.
- Built Adelante, a multi-tenant youth-ministry discipleship platform (React, Express, Socket.IO) with a five-stage pathway, moderated messaging with an audit log, QR event attendance and diocese-level reporting.
- Prototyped Pray Serve companion hardware: an nRF52840 BLE parish beacon with a Web Bluetooth admin console, a parametric KiCad prayer ring whose generator runs 558 design checks, and an ESP32-S3 church compass with LVGL and GNSS.

Cloud FinOps Consultant

MVG Consulting (05/2024 – Present)

- Prototyped a bilingual (English and Spanish), citation-backed HR assistant for the Diocese of Orange: hybrid BM25 and BGE-M3 retrieval with a refusal gate on Qwen2.5-14B over RunPod serverless vLLM; on a 30-question evaluation, 90% end-to-end correct, zero fabrications and 100% citation discipline.
- Partner with multiple organizations, including Axiom and the Diocese of Orange County, to optimize cloud infrastructure and implement FinOps best practices, achieving up to 70% reductions in compute costs.
- Design cost-efficient ETL pipelines using AWS Glue, reducing operational expenses by thousands of dollars annually through selective data updates and dynamic workflows.
- Implement optimized S3 storage architecture, minimizing storage costs for historical data while enabling advanced analytics and compliance reporting.
- Deliver insights through dashboards for historical and trend analysis, improving decision-making and stakeholder collaboration.

Contract FinOps Analyst

CVS Health (09/2023 – 11/2023)

- Conducted financial analysis to identify cloud cost trends and forecast expenses, contributing to actionable cost-saving strategies leveraging Snowflake.
- Aligned cloud budgets with financial goals through collaboration with IT and finance teams.
- Delivered financial reports to senior management, highlighting opportunities for optimization and improved resource utilization.
- Led resource tagging initiatives, achieving significant cost reductions by eliminating untagged and underutilized resources.

Cloud FinOps Analyst

Ingram Micro (09/2022 – 07/2023)

- Developed a Python-based AWS cost analysis tool, reducing multi-account data retrieval times and improving financial transparency.
- Addressed inefficiencies in cloud infrastructure, resulting in improved performance and cost savings of up to 25%.
- Played a pivotal role in aligning cloud operations with business growth strategies, enhancing cost governance and operational effectiveness.

Business Analyst

Tokio Marine America (02/2022 – 08/2022)

- Conducted business analysis and process improvement initiatives supporting enterprise operations.

Data Management Specialist

Magis Center for Reason and Faith (01/2020 – 03/2022)

- Managed the data systems and processes behind the Center's operations, the groundwork for the MagisAI infrastructure role that followed.

Cloud Business Analyst

Ingram Micro (07/2013 – 04/2018)

- Designed and integrated e-commerce systems for Ingram Micro, Amazon (AWS), and CloudChecker, supporting a $24 million annual revenue business.
- Collaborated with C-level executives to produce and manage analytical dashboards and reporting.
- Successfully managed $60 million worth of annual transactional billing and processing for Ingram Micro's cloud division.
- Improved billing processes by expediting invoice delivery and shortening billing cycles by 10 business days.
- Trained and mentored associates globally on business and technical processes.
- Engaged with vendor stakeholders for long-term planning and roadmap development, focusing on revenue growth and ROI optimization.

Shipped Apps

- **MagisAI:** App Store · Google Play
- **Pray Serve:** App Store · Google Play

Military Service

Lance Corporal, United States Marine Corps

(2010 – 2014)